

chose the latter, and was forcefully given strong doses of female hormones. In 1954, he was found dead due to cyanide poisoning, and is considered to have committed suicide. In 2009, thanks to an online petition by geeks from all over the world, then British Prime Minister Gordon Brown finally issued a posthumous public apology to Turing for the way the British government had treated him over 50 years ago.

Turing is also very famous for coming up with the Turing test. At a time where there weren't any computers in existence that could even partake in such a test, Turing asked the question, "Are there imaginable digital computers which would do well in the imitation game?" Even today, the Turing test, or tests that are inspired by his original thought are what we subject AI candidates to in order to tell if they truly are intelligent or not. You can read more about the Turing test in the next chapter.

Although Turing was obviously the most important human mind behind the beginnings of artificial intelligence, it was the American John McCarthy who coined the actual term "Artificial Intelligence" that all of us use today. McCarthy also developed the Lisp (List Processing) programming language, which is the second-oldest high level programming language ever, and was pretty instrumental to AI development in the early days. Although he has many accomplishments, one in particular we want to highlight; in 1961, before many of us were born, and certainly before all of us had even had a chance to use a computer, McCarthy said in a speech that computer time sharing technologies, and even specific applications would one day be sold as a utility – much like water and electricity. Although enough people probably thought he was crazy, over 50 years later, all of us are inundated with reminders of cloud storage, cloud hosting and cloud computing in general – talk about visionaries!

Other big names in early AI research include Marvin Minsky, Allen Newell and Herbert Simon. Minsky co-founded Massachusetts Institute of Technology's Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence laboratory with John McCarthy in 1959. He was among the first to analyse artificial neural networks, and his latest book titled *The Emotion Machine* (2006) is something we would recommend to everyone interested in the subject of AI.

Herbert Simon was a multi-talented individual who contributed to cognitive psychology, AI, computer science and sociology, amongst